

Giang Vu Le

PhD Student in Economics

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EDUCATION

PhD in Economics

2024 – Present

IMT School for Advanced Studies Lucca, Italy

Master of Arts in Economic Policy

2022 – 2024

Central European University, Vienna, Austria

Bachelor of Engineering in Aeronautical Engineering

2018 – 2022

Ho Chi Minh City University of Technology, Vietnam

RESEARCH

Work in Progress

“Picking the Right Winners? Optimal Policy Learning and Subsidies”

with Armando Rungi. Draft in preparation.

Abstract. We study the firm-level impact of German subsidies aimed at energy efficiency and evaluate whether alternative targeting rules could improve policy outcomes. We combine double machine learning with an optimal policy learning framework to estimate ex post heterogeneous treatment effects and derive ex ante optimal allocation rules. Applying a doubly robust learner, we find that subsidies increase capital stock and employment, on average, while documenting substantial heterogeneity across firms, indicating scope for improving targeting. Therefore, we assess two policies, each of which maximizes either employment or value added. We show how the employment-maximizing policy would disproportionately target smaller firms and yield larger job gains, while the value-added-maximizing policy would favor larger firms, leading to greater output and labor productivity.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- Organizer of the CIML Training & Conference “Frontiers of Causal Inference and Machine Learning” *2026*
- Organizer of the IMT Lucca Reading Group - Policy challenges: international economics, geopolitics, and global innovation *2025 – 2026*
- Organizer of the Global Firms and Knowledge Diffusion Workshop *2025*
- Organizer of the CIML Training & Conference “Frontiers of Causal Inference and Machine Learning” *2025*

PRESENTATIONS & CONFERENCES

- CIML Training & Conference “Frontiers of Causal Inference and Machine Learning”, Lucca, Italy *2025*

AWARDS & HONORS

- Outstanding Thesis Award in the MA in Economic Policy in Global Markets Program (2023/24), Central European University, Austria
- Outstanding Academic Achievement Award for the highest GPA in the department (2023/24), Central European University, Austria